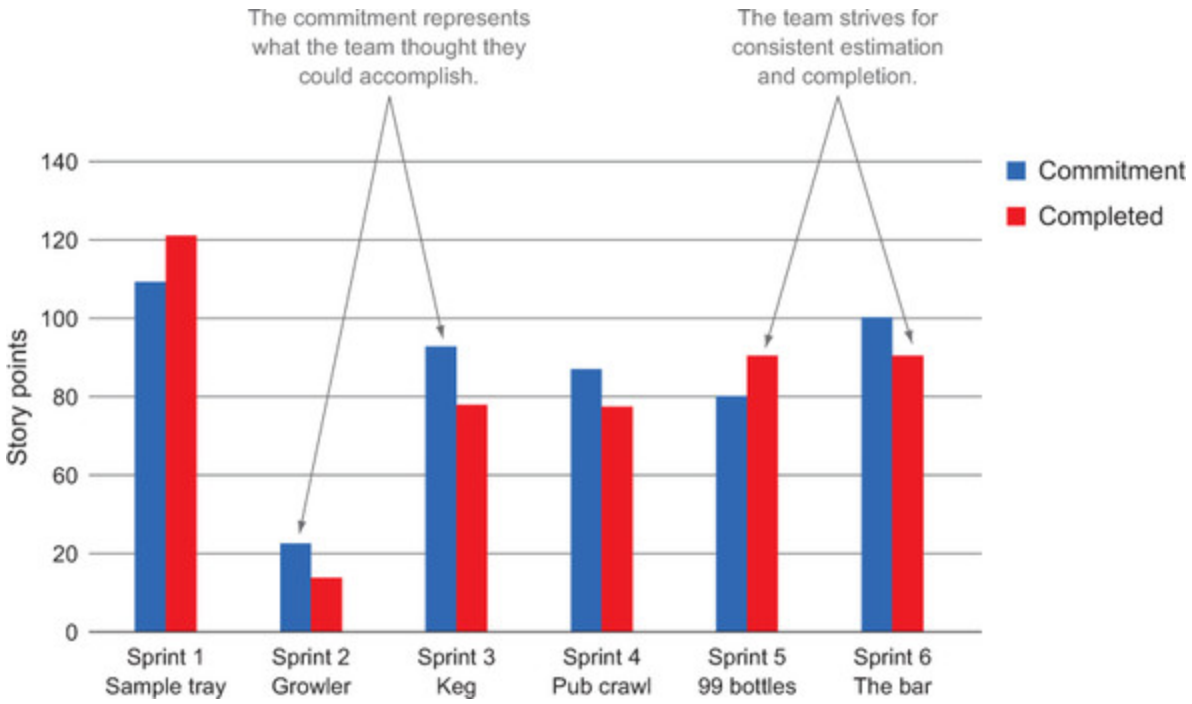


Velocity can be calculated by graphing the amount you estimated against the amount you actually got done. Velocity ends up implying a few things about your team:

- How good your team is at estimating work
- How consistently your team gets work done
- How consistently your team can make and meet commitments

Even though velocity is a staple agile metric, its relative nature makes it difficult to pinpoint where problems really are. If velocity is inconsistent, there could be a number of issues, such as:

- Your team is not doing a good job at estimating.
- Your team has commitment issues.
- Scope could be changing in the middle of your development cycle.
- You may be hitting troublesome tech debt.

The key data point behind velocity that we'll be working with is the estimates your team puts on their tasks. We'll be diving into estimations later in the chapter and breaking them down against other data points in chapter 7.